Headset and microphone not working in calls

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Summary

This article provides guidance for resolving headset and microphone issues that affect audio in Microsoft Teams calls. It outlines common symptoms, likely causes, a self-help procedure for users, and a detailed service-desk workflow for Desktop Support agents. Follow the steps to isolate the problem, apply fixes, and verify resolution before closing the ticket.

Symptoms

- No audio heard in Teams meetings
- Others cannot hear the user's voice
- Microphone shows as muted or unavailable in Teams settings
- Bluetooth headset fails to pair or disconnects during a call
- Wired headset produces static or no sound when plugged into the audio jack

Common causes

- Incorrect default audio device selected in Windows/macOS sound settings
- Teams client configured to use the wrong microphone or speaker
- Bluetooth driver outdated or headset not properly paired
- Physical damage to headset cable, connector, or mute switch
- Headset disabled or muted via hardware buttons or OS volume mixer
- Conflicting audio software (e.g., third-party VoIP apps) taking exclusive control of the device

Overview

Headset and microphone problems are among the most frequent hardware tickets received by the Desktop Support team. The issue may stem from software configuration, Bluetooth pairing, or physical faults. Following the steps below helps isolate the cause quickly and determines whether a simple re-pair, settings change, or hardware replacement is needed.

Self-Help Troubleshooting Steps for Users

Users can often resolve headset/mic issues without contacting the service desk. Perform the following checks in order; stop as soon as audio works in a test Teams call.

1. 1. Verify the headset is physically connected: - For wired headsets, ensure the 3.5 mm plug is fully inserted into the laptop's audio/combo jack. - For USB headsets, try a different USB port. - For Bluetooth headsets, confirm the device shows as Connected in the OS Bluetooth settings.
2. 2. Check the system's default audio devices: - Windows: Right-click the speaker icon -> Sounds -> Playback and Recording tabs. Set the headset as the default device for both playback and recording. - macOS: Apple menu -> System Settings -> Sound -> Output and Input. Select the headset.
3. 3. Test the headset outside Teams: - Play an audio file or use the Voice Recorder app to confirm you can hear output. - Speak into the mic and listen to the playback to verify input.
4. 4. In Microsoft Teams, select the correct device: - Click your profile picture -> Settings -> Devices. - Under Audio devices, choose the headset for Speaker and Microphone. - Make a test call to confirm both sides work.
5. 5. For Bluetooth headsets, re-pair if needed: - Remove the device from Bluetooth settings, then put the headset in pairing mode and add it again. - After reconnection, repeat steps 2-4.
6. 6. If the headset still does not work, try it on another known-good computer (or use a different headset on your machine) to isolate whether the fault lies with the headset or the PC.

Service Desk Agent Procedure

When a user reports headset or microphone issues, follow this structured workflow to diagnose, remediate, and

document the incident.

1. 1. Gather details: ask for headset make/model, connection type (wired/USB/Bluetooth), and exact error messages observed in Teams.
2. 2. Have the user verify physical connections and retry using a different USB port or audio jack if applicable.
3. 3. Check OS sound settings: - On Windows, open Settings -> System -> Sound and confirm the headset is selected as output and input. - On macOS, open System Settings -> Sound and verify selection.
4. 4. In Microsoft Teams, navigate to Settings -> Devices and ensure the correct speaker and microphone are chosen. Conduct a test call.
5. 5. For Bluetooth headsets, remove the device from Bluetooth settings, place the headset in pairing mode, and re-pair. Then repeat steps 3-4.
6. 6. Test the headset on another known-good computer (or use a different headset on the user's machine) to isolate hardware vs. PC issues.
7. 7. If the headset is defective, issue a replacement from Desktop Support stock and update the asset record.
8. 8. Document all steps taken and the final resolution in the ticket.

Verification and Closure

After applying a fix, confirm that the headset works correctly in a Teams call and that the user can both hear and be heard. Ask the user to place a test call or use the Teams "Make a test call" feature. Once verified, close the ticket with a summary of the cause and solution.

When to escalate

If the headset is determined to be faulty after troubleshooting and replacement stock is exhausted, escalate to the Desktop Support Team Lead or the Asset Management group for procurement. Include the headset model, serial number, a summary of troubleshooting steps performed, and any relevant error logs or screenshots.

Keywords: headset, microphone, Teams audio, Bluetooth headset, wired headset, no sound, mic not working, audio device